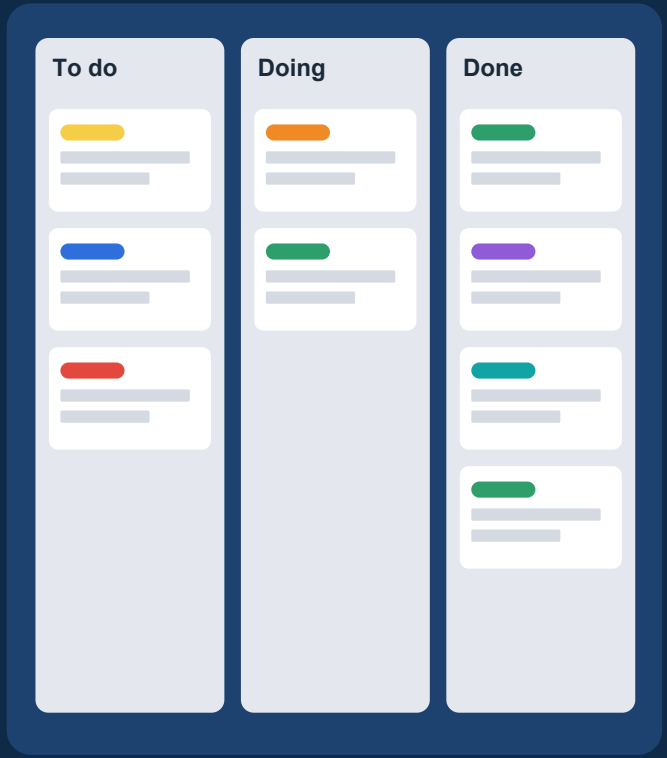
TMA3084 · SOFTWARE ENGINEERING LAB

Agile Project Management with Trello

101 — 2026 Edition

Semester 1, 2026/2027 · Universiti Malaysia Sarawak



BASICS

Trello's building blocks



Workspace

Your team's home. One per TMA3084 group; holds members and boards.



Board

One project or sprint system, e.g. “G1 · Campus Clinic App”.



List

A workflow stage: Backlog, Doing, In Review, Done…



Card

One user story, bug or task, moving left → right.

INSIDE A CARD

Labels | Members | Start & due dates | Checklists | Attachments & links | Comments & activity

New for personal productivity: Inbox (capture tasks from email, chat and mobile) and Planner (drag cards into your calendar).

PLANS

Free plan works — if you plan your seats

10

collaborators per Workspace

10

boards per Workspace

250

automation runs per month

10 MB

maximum file attachment

Count your seats

- Team (up to 6) + client + demonstrator + lecturer ≈ 9 of 10 seats.
- Everyone else: share a read-only board link instead of inviting them.
- Over 10 collaborators, the whole Workspace becomes view-only.
- Large files (APK, videos) go on Drive or GitHub Releases — attach the link.
- Paid views (Timeline, Dashboard) come with a 14-day Premium trial; Atlassian also offers education discounts.

TMA3084 TOOLCHAIN

Where Trello fits in your project



Client & PO

Needs, feedback, acceptance



Trello

Backlog, sprints, stand-ups, client comments



GitHub

Issues, branches, PRs, Actions CI



TSPi workbook

LOGT, LOGD, LOGAI, WEEK

One task, one home

The Trello card holds the user story and its conversation. The GitHub issue/PR holds the code. Link them with the card ID (e.g. US-07) and the GitHub Power-Up — never retype the same task in two places.

SETUP · SCRUM MASTER

Setting up your team Workspace

1. **Create the Workspace**
   Name it TMA3084-G<group>-<TeamName>; keep visibility Private.

2. **Invite the team first**
   Then the client and your demonstrator — count seats as you go.

3. **Assign admins**
   Product Owner and Scrum Master become Workspace admins.

4. **Real names & photos**
   So everyone can see who owns what and who is online.

5. **Create the sprint board**
   Use the list structure on the next slide.

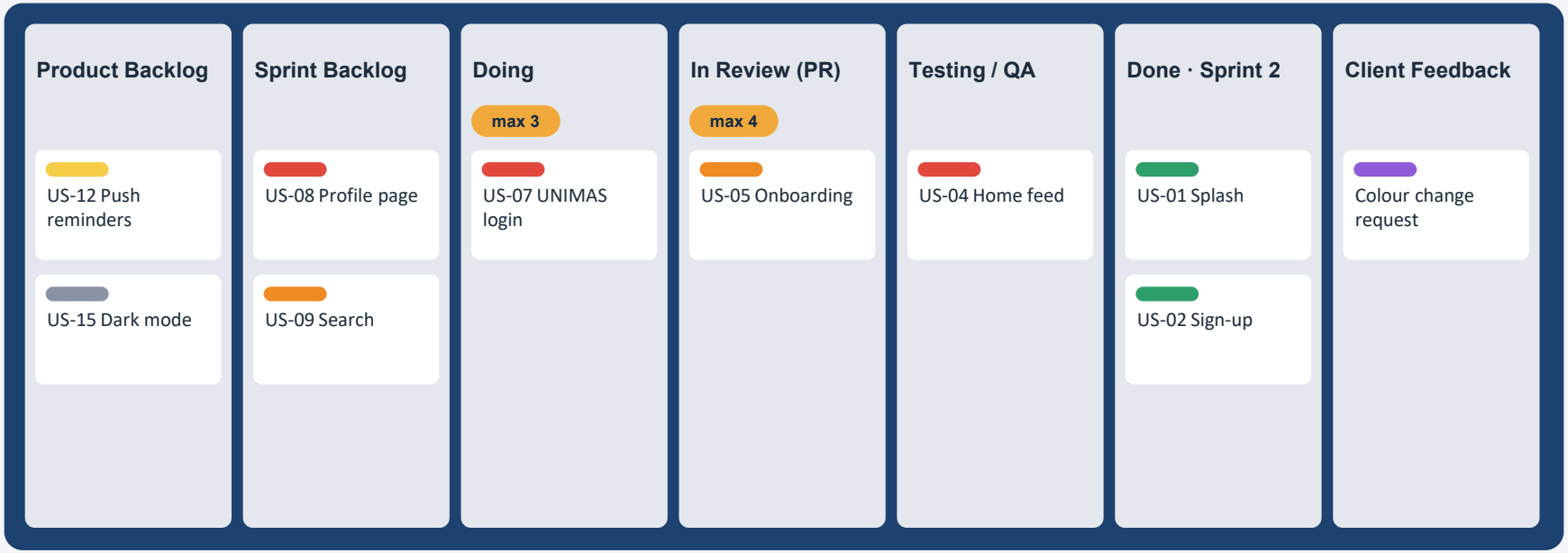
6. **Add Power-Ups**
   GitHub, Voting, List Limits and Card Aging.

7. **Calendar & notifications**
   Week starts Monday; turn on mobile and email alerts.

8. **Share the board link**
   Post it in your team charter and README.

BOARD TEMPLATE

Recommended sprint board for TMA3084



Cards flow left → right. The PO orders the Product Backlog; the team pulls into Doing only when there is room under the WIP limit. Accepted work is archived at the end of each sprint.

LABELS

A shared label scheme

Priority (MoSCoW)

Must have	Needed for the milestone demo
Should have	Important, not critical
Could have	Nice if time allows
Won't (this time)	Parked, visible to the client

Type & status

Feature	User-facing functionality
Bug	Logged in LOGD too
Docs / Report	SRS, SDD, manual
AI feature	Uses Claude / GPT / Gemini API
Blocked	Needs help — @mention the SM

Name every label (not just a colour) and switch on colour-blind-friendly patterns in your account settings.

ROLES

Who does what on the board



Product Owner

Owns and orders the Product Backlog, writes and accepts stories, and is the main link to the client.



Scrum Master

Workspace admin. Runs the ceremonies, clears Blocked cards, and keeps the board honest and tidy.



Development Team

Tech Lead, Flutter developers, QA and Docs Lead. Pull cards, update them daily, link PRs and tests.



Stakeholders

Client, lecturer and demonstrator. Comment, vote and review demos — they don't move cards.

WORKING AGREEMENT

Ground rules for the team

THE ORIGINAL FIVE — STILL TRUE

- Be honest: surface a concern, doubt or problem immediately.
- If you're unhappy with something a teammate did, raise it with them first.
- Try to resolve it together before escalating to the lecturer.
- If escalation is needed, tell your teammates in advance.
- No retribution for admitting a mistake or speaking honestly.

ADDED FOR DISTRIBUTED TEAMS



Decisions live on the card

Comment on the card, not in private chats.



Update before stand-up

Move and comment on your cards first.



Answer @mentions in 24 h

Even if it's just “seen, back Friday”.

SPRINT CADENCE

One sprint, five events

← *about 2 weeks* →



Planning 1
What will we build?

Planning 2
How will we build it?

Daily stand-up
Sync & unblock

Review
Demo to the client

Retrospective
Improve the process

SPRINTS LEAD INTO THE COURSE MILESTONES

M1 **Week 5**
Proposal & SRS

M2 **Week 9**
SDD & prototype

M3 **Week 13**
Tests, CI/CD, APK

M4 **Week 15**
Release & demo

PLANNING 1 · WHAT

Collect requirements as user stories

STORY FORMAT

As a **<role>**
I want **<capability>**
so that **<benefit>**

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA (GIVEN / WHEN / THEN)

Given the starting context

When the user does something

Then this observable result happens

Must Feature

US-07 · Log in with UNIMAS email [5]

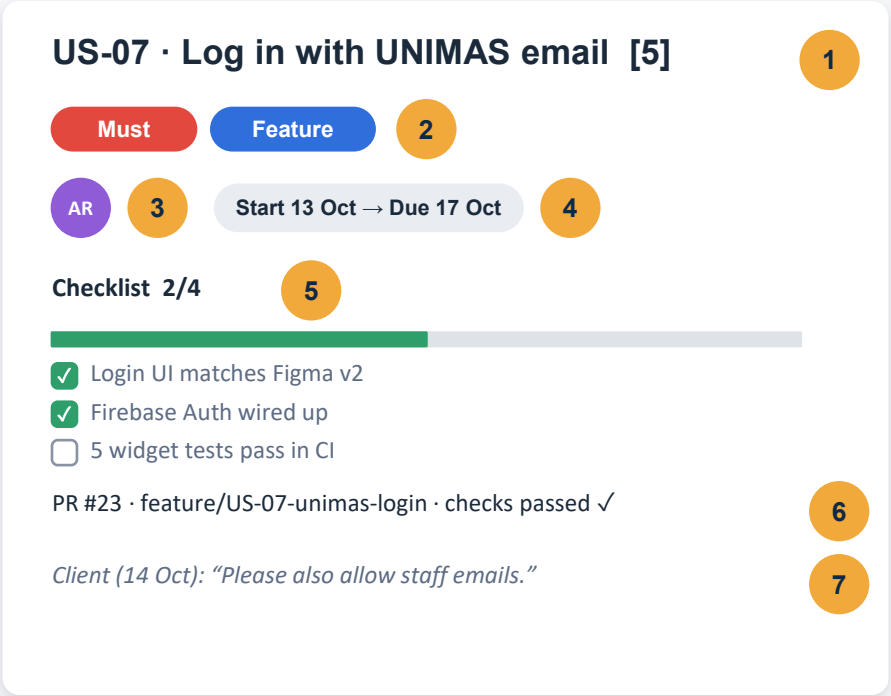
As a student, I want to log in with my UNIMAS email so that my clinic bookings stay private.

Given a registered siswa.unimas.my account,
When I enter valid credentials and tap Log in,
Then I see my Home screen within 2 seconds.

I N V E S T good stories are INVEST

CARD ANATOMY

What a complete story card contains



1. **ID, title & points**
   Short, searchable; ID links Trello, GitHub and your SRS.
2. **Labels**
   One priority + one type.
3. **Members**
   The accountable person(s).
4. **Start & due dates**
   Due by the sprint Review, not the milestone.
5. **Checklist**
   The shippables — each item SMART.
6. **Links & attachments**
   PR, design, docs. Big files as links.
7. **Comments & activity**
   The decision log markers will read.

PLANNING 1 · PRIORITISE

Ordering the backlog



Vote

- Enable the Voting Power-Up.
- Team and client vote on cards.
- Votes inform — the PO decides.



Label

- Tag each story Must / Should / Could / Won't.
- Filter by label to check the Must list fits the sprint.



Date

- Due date = the sprint Review date.
- On paid plans, typing “…by Friday” in a new card's title sets the due date for you.

Position is priority. The top card of the Product Backlog is always the next most valuable thing to build.

PLANNING 2 · HOW

Define shippables and split big stories

Checklist = shippables

S M A R T every item

WEAK

- [ ] Do login

SMART

- [ ] Login screen passes 5 widget tests in CI by Thu
- [ ] Wrong password shows error in < 1 s
- [ ] PR reviewed by 1 teammate before merge

Too big for one sprint?

Open the checklist item's menu and choose Convert to card. Move the new card back to the Product Backlog.

AI checklists (paid plans)

Trello can suggest a checklist from the card's title and description. Treat it as a draft: edit it until the team owns every item.

PLANNING 2 · DELEGATE

Delegate and keep track

Accountable

Add yourself as the card's member (or drag your avatar onto it). One owner per card.

Informed

Watch a card, list or board to be notified of every change. Replaces “Subscribe”.

Filter

Filter the board by member, label or due date. Keyboard shortcut: press F.

Notifications

The bell shows mentions, assignments and due dates. Get alerts on mobile too.

@mentions

Pull a teammate into a card's discussion with @username.

Checklist items

Assign an item and give it its own due date for sub-tasks.

DAILY STAND-UP

Stand-ups for a distributed team

EVERY MEMBER ANSWERS

1. What did I finish since last time?
2. What will I do next?
3. What is blocking me?



Live — 15 minutes

On Teams, Google Meet or Zoom. Share the board, walk it right to left, cameras on.



Async — when schedules clash

Each member comments on a “Stand-up · <date>” card by an agreed time; the SM reads them all.

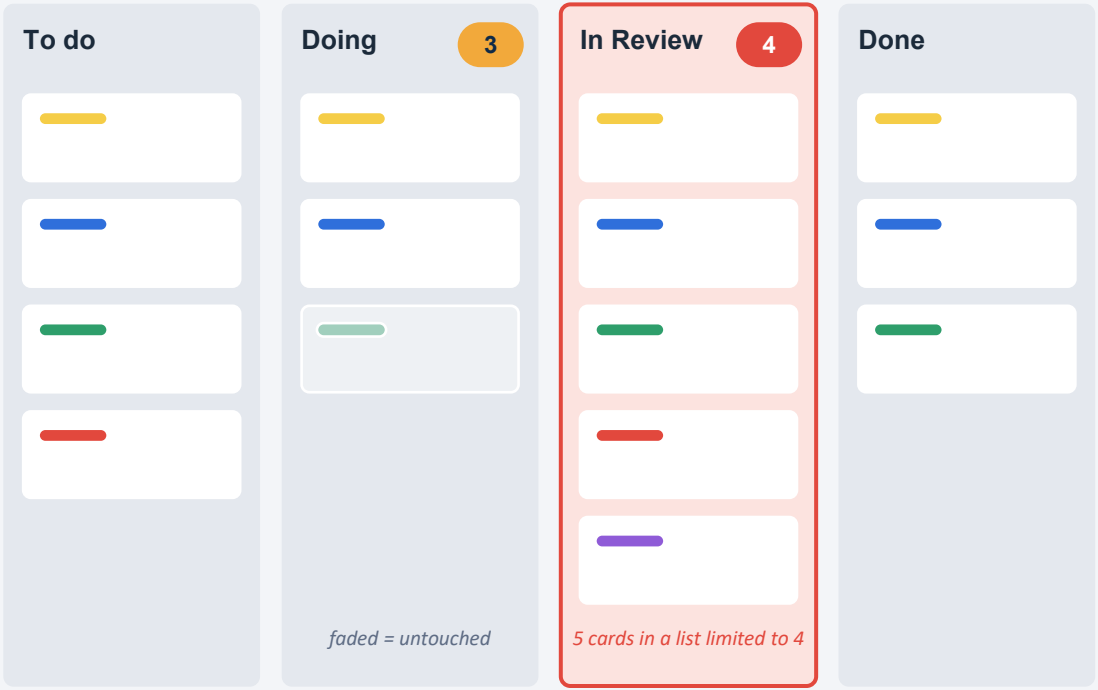


Blockers

Add the Blocked label and @mention the Scrum Master. Solve it after the stand-up, not during.

KANBAN FLOW

Limit work in progress, spot stale cards



List Limits Power-Up

Set a maximum per list. The list turns red when it is over the limit.

Pull, don't push

Take a new card only when you finish one. Help clear In Review before starting more.

Card Aging Power-Up

Cards nobody has touched slowly fade. A faded card is a stand-up topic.

AUTOMATION

Let the board do the chores

WHEN	**A card is moved into “Doing”**	THEN	Add me as a member and set the start date to today
WHEN	**A card is moved into “Done · Sprint N”**	THEN	Mark the due date complete
WHEN	**The “Blocked” label is added**	THEN	Post a comment: @scrummaster please help
WHEN	**1 day before a card is due**	THEN	Comment @card to remind its members



Find it under Automation on the board menu.

- Rules: trigger → action
- Buttons: one-click routines, e.g. “Start sprint”
- Free plan: 250 runs a month for the whole Workspace — keep rules few.

GITHUB LINK

From card to merged code

Trello card

US-07 moves to Doing

Branch

feature/US-07-unimas-login

Pull request

“US-07: UNIMAS login” ≥ 1 reviewer

Actions CI

analyze + test pass

Merge

into develop; card → Testing

GitHub Power-Up

Attach the branch, commits, issue or pull request to the card. Its status shows on the card, so the PO and client can follow progress without opening GitHub.

Naming convention

Put the card ID in the branch, commit messages and PR title. Keep the [AI-assisted] commit tag and LOGAI entry for Copilot-generated code.

AI features — and how to use them honestly

Build a board with AI

Describe a goal; Trello drafts lists and cards.

Merge duplicate cards

Drag one card onto another; originals are archived.

AI-generated checklists

Steps suggested from the card's title and description.

Due date from the title

“Submit SRS by Friday” sets the due date.

Focus-time suggestions

Finds calendar time to work on a card.

Trello MCP

Connect AI assistants such as Claude to read and update cards.

The first five need a paid plan (Standard, Premium or Enterprise; July 2026 rollout).

AI proposes, the team decides

- Review every AI-drafted story or checklist before accepting it.
- Requirements come from your client, not from a prompt.
- Note AI use in a card comment.

VIEWS & DEVICES

Seeing the same work in different ways

Board

All plans

Daily work and stand-ups.

Inbox

All plans

Capture ideas from email, chat or phone; sort later.

Calendar

Paid

Cards by due date; spot crowded weeks.

Timeline

Paid

Milestone plan for the M1 proposal.

Dashboard

Paid

Charts by list, member, label for reports.

Mobile apps

All plans

iOS and Android; notifications on the go.

SPRINT REVIEW

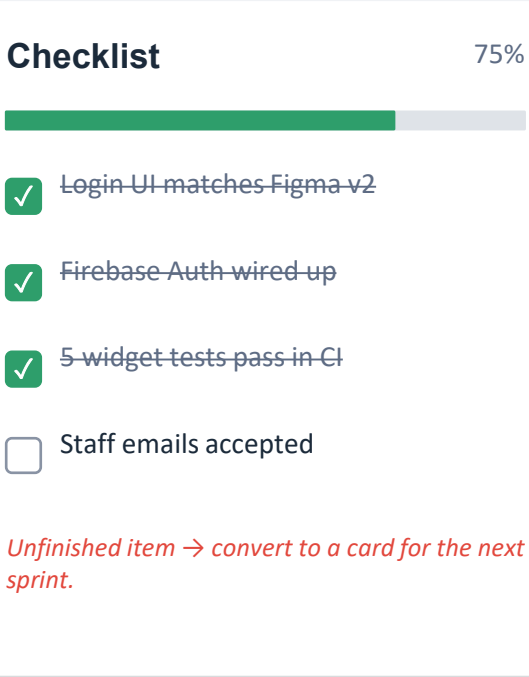
Validate the work with your client

Check — Open each card in Testing and confirm every checklist item is ticked.

Demo — Show the running app (emulator or APK) to the client — not slides.

Decide — Client accepts → Done. Not yet → back to the backlog with a comment saying why.

Record — Attach the release link, demo video and test report to the cards.



RETROSPECTIVE

Improve the process, keep what works

Start	Stop	Continue
Async stand-ups on non-lab days	Merging PRs without a reviewer	Demo on a real phone
Pairing on PR reviews	Moving cards the night before	Client comments on cards

Run it as a Start / Stop / Continue board; vote on one change to try next sprint.

Update your process assets

Card templates: make a story and a bug card into templates (card menu → Make template).

Definition of Done: keep it as a checklist you copy into every card.

Lessons learned: a list the next project can reuse.

Archive, don't delete: archived cards can be restored; deleting a card, comment or attachment is permanent.

ASSESSMENT

Using the board as evidence

Screenshots

Capture the board at each sprint Planning and Review.

Activity history

Shows who moved what, and when. Cards update steadily, not all on the last night.

Board export

Export the board as JSON at each milestone and keep it with your submission.

Traceability

Use the same IDs (US-07) in the SRS, SDD, test plan, GitHub and LOGT.

What markers look for: clear ownership of every card, steady movement across the sprint, client comments on accepted work, and a board that matches your GitHub history.

PITFALLS

Five habits that sink student boards

Everything in Doing	Ten cards in progress means nothing is finished. Respect the WIP limit.
Ownerless cards	If nobody's face is on it, nobody is doing it.
Decisions in WhatsApp	If it isn't on the card, the team (and the marker) can't see it.
The midnight shuffle	Moving 20 cards the night before a milestone shows up in the activity log.
A board graveyard	Stale cards and unused lists. Archive at every Review.

REFERENCES

References and further reading

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   trello.com/guide
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   support.atlassian.com/trello
3. **Atlassian Support — Collaborator limit for free Workspaces**
   support.atlassian.com/trello/docs/workspace-user-limit
4. **Atlassian (30 Jul 2026) — The Board Should Work For You**
   atlassian.com/blog/trello/the-board-should-work-for-you
5. **Trello pricing and plan comparison**
   trello.com/pricing
6. **Schwaber, K. & Sutherland, J. (2020) — The Scrum Guide**
   scrumguides.org
7. **Original deck: Phung Thanh Cuong (2013) — Agile Project Management with Trello 101**
   Professional Management Academy, pma.edu.vn

Your board is your team's shared memory.

Keep it honest, keep it current, and let it speak for your work.

NEXT STEP

Before your first client meeting: create the Workspace, set up the sprint board, add your labels and Power-Ups, and write your first three user stories with acceptance criteria.